Progress on SDG17 [Partnerships for The Goals]

Mawlana Bhashani Science and Technology University (MBSTU) recognizes the critical importance of SDG 17, focusing on strengthening the means of implementation and revitalizing global partnerships for sustainable development. The university actively engages in a wide range of collaborations with national and international institutions, emphasizing research, knowledge exchange, and capacity building to advance the entire sustainable development agenda.

MBSTU's commitment to SDG 17 is demonstrated through its deep involvement in multi-stakeholder policy development and implementation. The university provides direct input into national governance through its faculty members, such as Professor Dr. Mohammad Omar Faruk from the Department of Criminology and Police Science served as an expert panel member on the Police Commission under the Ministry of Home Affairs of Bangladesh. This involvement ensures that academic insights and evidence-based policy strategies are integrated into key areas like security and justice (SDG 16) and are aligned with national SDG efforts. Furthermore, MBSTU actively initiates and participates in cross-sectoral dialogues by organizing seminars, such as the one on "Violence, Oppression and Fear: A Chronicle of Human Rights Violations in Bangladesh," which brought together policymakers, NGO representatives (like the Bangladesh Institute of Labour Studies and Society for Social Service), and university stakeholders to address human rights and labor issues (SDG 8 and SDG 16). The university maintains ongoing institutional partnerships with NGOs like the Society for Social Service (SSS), the Bangladesh Institute of Legal Studies (BILS), and the Bangladesh Institute of Social Research Trust (BISRT) to address social issues like gender equality (SDG 5) and social justice through joint projects and awareness campaigns, which directly contribute to sustainable social development outcomes.

In addition to domestic partnerships, MBSTU significantly contributes to global knowledge sharing and capacity building through international collaborations. The university has established a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Kongju National University (KNU), Republic of Korea, to strengthen cooperation in education, research, and innovation, specifically through the development of the Department of Mechanical Engineering and the Mechanical and Automotive Engineering Education Centre (SDG 4, SDG 9, and SDG 17). Another key partnership is the MoU with the Center for Marine Environmental Studies (CMES), Ehime University, Japan, which facilitates the exchange of staff, publications, and data to advance research on marine and environmental sustainability (SDG 4, SDG 14, and SDG 17). This collaborative research focuses on reviewing comparative approaches and developing international best practices on tackling the SDGs. Through these varied and active partnerships, MBSTU demonstrates its fundamental role in leveraging multi-stakeholder and global collaboration to strengthen the means of implementation for sustainable development.